

4.1.2 Migrating From 98 To XP?

If you're using Windows 98, you'd want to know what's different in XP. But before we move on to the differences between the two operating systems, we should tell you that Microsoft withdrew support for Windows 98 a long time ago! It's true that there were initial hardware and software compatibility issues when XP was first released on October 25th 2001—that's why people took time to switch to XP. But with time, all games and software are now programmed to run better on XP. And with the arrival of Service Pack 2 (Windows XP SP2), the stability of the OS as well as hardware support has improved considerably.

So here are the main differences between 98 and XP.

- Windows XP needs to emulate the MS-DOS environment, whereas a user can log in to MS-DOS mode from Windows 98.
- Windows XP supports the NTFS file system in addition to FAT 16 and 32 (refer §3.3).
- System Restore in XP allows you to restore the OS to a previous state. There is no such feature in Windows 98.
- By using Hibernate, Windows XP users can resume using their machine from the point they last turned it off. This is not available in Windows 98.
- Windows XP is a better multimedia-based OS than Windows 98 is. It has photo sharing and printing, native CD writing, and a better Windows Media Player.
- Since DirectX is built in to Windows XP, it becomes an ideal choice for gaming.
- Fast switching between users is possible in Windows XP; a user can lock his screen and allow another user to log in right then.
- The power management feature of Windows XP is superior to that of Windows 98. That's why most retail laptops come with XP loaded.
- Remote Desktop in XP allows a user to log in to his machine using another machine over the same network or via the Internet.